

INSTITUTIONAL
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2025
Fixed Income
Trading Summit

October 20–21, 2025
Park Hyatt Chicago
Chicago, IL

TraderForum



Welcome

Join over 70 buy-side professionals for a summit concentrating on the critical trends shaping the fixed income market, providing your annual “business check” on how your peers are handling the same issues as you. This meeting is open for fixed income traders, portfolio managers, and heads of fixed income based in North America. This special two-day event will host topical discussions, breakout sessions, and thought-provoking presentations.

Sponsoring Organizations

TraderForum would like to thank the following sponsors for devoting their effort, time, and resources to help with our 2025 Fixed Income Trading Summit.












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- Michael Nappi, Executive Director, Portfolio Management & Trading, Parametric
- Matthew Murphy, Fixed Income Electronic Trading & Market Structure Specialist, T. Rowe Price
- Tim Gigliotti, Sr., Managing Director, Head of Taxable Fixed Income Trading, TIAA

Agenda

Monday, October 20, 2025

1:00–1:20

Registration
Salon Foyer

1:20–1:30

Opening Remarks
Salons ABC

Presented by:
Lew Knox, Executive Director, Institutional Investor

1:30–2:15

AI and Fixed Income Investing: A Case Study
Salons ABC

Case Study followed by Delegate Discussions
We kick off with a case study on how Nelumbium Capital applies generative AI, agent-based modeling, and graph analytics to fixed income investing. By connecting micro- and macroeconomics through the lens of complexity economics, Nelumbium’s approach anticipates vulnerabilities, simulates contagion, and quantifies systemic risk. We’ll follow the case study with delegate discussions on how buy-side trading desks are adopting generative AI.

Presented by:
Abhishek Sinha, CEO, Nelumbium Capital

2:15–3:00

Breakout Discussion Groups
Salons ABC and Salon D

Delegates will choose one discussion group to attend below.

I. Working with Data and Automation on the Trading Desk
Salons ABC

How can fixed income trading desks work with limited budget and resources to incorporate data, analytics, and workflow automation into the trading process? Where is the greatest opportunity and what are the greatest challenges in fixed income trading automation today? How can traders work most effectively with in-house IT organization and with vendors?

Discussion Leader:
Lindsey Spink, Head of Global Trading, FIC, American Century

II. Evaluating Your Liquidity Providers

Salon D

How do buy-side trading desks evaluate their liquidity providers? What factors are considered, and how many are quantitative vs qualitative? How do the criteria differ when considering electronic liquidity providers versus banks? How often do buy-side desks score their brokers, and who participates in the scorecarding process? And how much information do buy-side desks disclose to their brokers about their wallet share?

Discussion Leader:

Jeff Jones, High Yield Trader, Northern Trust Asset Management

3:00–3:45**Using AI-Driven Tools to Reshape Credit Fixed Income Workflows**

Salons ABC

The ongoing evolution of technology, particularly in AI, is reshaping the landscape of credit fixed income markets. Core investment functions such as market monitoring, price discovery, relative value analysis, portfolio evaluation, and portfolio optimization are increasingly benefiting from more automated and data-driven methodologies. This panel will explore a practical technology-based solution designed to support these critical functions. The discussion will focus on how such tools can streamline workflows, enhance the quality and speed of investment decision-making, and improve operational efficiency across trading, research, and portfolio management functions.

Presented by:

- Chris Floyd, Head of Institutional Sales, Bondway.ai
- Brad Visokey, Head of Product Development, Bondway.ai

3:45–4:15**Coffee Break**

Salon Foyer

4:15–5:00**The Outlook for Growth and Inflation**

Salons ABC

How has the outlook for the dollar, government bond yields, inflation, and economic growth changed since Donald Trump's April tariff announcements, and how should fixed income investors navigate an ever more uncertain environment for rates and credit? What corporate sectors and asset classes will suffer more from a world with less trade, and which might benefit? Join us for a look into the cloudy – as possibly stormy – future of the US economy and financial markets.

Keynote Speaker:

Barry C. Knapp, Managing Partner, Ironsides Macroeconomics LLC; Chief Market Strategist, Ironsides MRA Institutional

5:00–6:00**Cocktail & Canapé Reception**

Salon Foyer

6:00**Evening Free for Dinner/Outside Social Engagements**

Tuesday, October 21, 2025

7:45–8:30

Registration and Breakfast
Salon Foyer and Drawing Room

8:30–8:40

Welcome Remarks
Salons ABC

Presented by:
Will Llamas, Executive Director, Content & Investor Relations, Institutional Investor

8:40–9:25

What's Next for Electronic Trading?
Salons ABC

Electronic trading continues to grow in the US fixed income markets, with some 44% of volume executed electronically in 2024, according to Coalition Greenwich. Volumes surged in April after the Trump tariff announcements, but fixed income trading was generally orderly. After years of growth in RFQ, all-to-all, and most recently portfolio trading, what's the next big protocol for electronic trading? Can better data and analytics help dealers and buy-side in price discovery? Can artificial intelligence help traders find liquidity more efficiently? Join our panel of buy- and sell-side market participants for a look into the near future of fixed income market structure.

Moderated by:
Dheeraj Kakar, Platform Manager, Dodge & Cox

Panelists:

- Phil Cichlar, Institutional Sales and Trading, Fixed Income Specialist, Jane Street
- Izzy Conlin, Managing Director, Head of US Credit, Tradeweb
- Justine Robertson, Managing Director, Head of U.S. Sales & Client Strategy, Trumid
- Lindsey Spink, Head of Global Trading, FIC, American Century
- Emily Wasco, Head of Americas Markets, Managing Director, Citigroup

9:25–10:10

Corporate Bond Index Futures: Ready for Takeoff?
Salons ABC

If volatility and risk provide fertile ground for derivatives trading, the spring of 2025 should produce a bumper year for corporate bond index futures. For example, the CBOE high-yield and investment-grade corporate bond index futures set records for open interest in the days following the Trump tariff announcements in April. CBOE isn't alone; CME, Eurex, and ICE also offer corporate bond index futures, with contracts available on US and European high-yield and investment-grade bonds and emerging markets bonds. In this session, we'll hear from portfolio managers and traders who use these relatively new products to hedge risk and manage exposures.

Panelists:

- Lee Bartholomew, Director and Co-Head of Derivatives Product & Market, Eurex
- Miguel Bilbao, Founder, CEO and CIO, Filon Capital
- Chad Cowden, Credit Derivatives Portfolio Manager, PGIM Fixed Income

10:10–10:25**Sea Changes in Portfolios and Ratings**

Salons ABC

Numerous industries have massively changed over the recent past with far-reaching effects. In our view, the credit rating industry is in the process of changing, with the result being a more efficient market. We will suggest a few paths for change and the impact on portfolios and trading and in turn how it will benefit your firm.

Presented by:

Sean Egan, Managing Director, Egan-Jones Ratings

10:25–10:45**Coffee Break**

Salon Foyer

10:45–11:30**The Role of the EMS on the Fixed Income Desk**

Salons ABC

The execution management system (EMS), long the centerpiece of buy-side equity trading automation, is far from ubiquitous on fixed income desks. Buy-side traders hope to use the EMS to consolidate data from multiple liquidity sources, automate workflows, and perform pre-trade analytics. In this session, we'll look at the case for using a fixed income EMS on a fixed income desk and discuss best practices for implementation. Can one EMS work across asset classes for a buy-side firm? How can investment managers integrate disparate systems with the EMS, and how can the EMS facilitate connection with counterparties and trading venues?

Panelists:

- Matt Murphy, Fixed Income Electronic Trading & Market Structure Specialist, T. Rowe Price
- Spencer Lee, Head of Client Products, Americas, MarketAxess
- Tim Gigliotti, SMD, Head of TFI Trading, Nuveen
- Vlad Rashkovich, Global Head of Trading Research & Analytics, Bloomberg

11:30–12:15**Synergistic Liquidity Effects of Fixed Income ETFs**

Salons ABC

Fixed income exchange-traded funds continue to attract assets, with AUM growing 18% in 2024, with active products growing even faster. On the back of these flows, portfolio trading continues to grow, accounting for 20% of all US dealer-to-client trading, according to a late 2024 Barclays study. Some analysts also see an increase in trading at the end of the day, driven by ETFs needing the closing price, and at the end of the month, as ETFs and other indexed portfolios rebalance. Do these volume increases offer buy-side traders a liquidity opportunity? In this session, we'll discuss the utility and growth of portfolio trading and other ETF-related flows and look into how ETFs may be changing liquidity patterns in the US fixed income market.

Moderated by:

Robert Fink, Buy-side Relationship Manager, North America, Coalition Greenwich

Panelists:

- Brian McMullen, Sr ETF Specialist, T. Rowe Price
- David Sharp, Director, ETF Capital Markets, Vanguard
- Jason Bloom, Director of Global Macro ETF Strategy, Invesco

12:15–12:45

Managing the Buyside-Sellside Relationship in the Modern Credit Marketplace

Salons ABC

Today's buyside corporate bond trader can call on banks, electronic market makers, and, through all-to-all trading protocols, even other buyside desks when sourcing liquidity. What must a modern credit dealer offer across algo, portfolio, and voice trading to compete? How does the buyside differentiate across those different types of liquidity? What role do repo, balance sheet, and new issue allocation play in dealer selection? Join us for a deep dive into how the buyside manages counterparties in a 21st-century credit market.

Moderated by:

Matt Barra, Co-Head of Investment Grade Credit Sales, Citadel Securities

Panelists:

- Will Boeckman, Head of Fixed Income Platform Sales, Citadel Securities
- Ryan Raymond, Head of US Trading, Legal & General Investment Management
- Ian Birtch, Senior Fixed Income Trader, Northern Trust Asset Management

12:45–1:45

Luncheon

Drawing Room

1:45–2:45

Breakout Discussion Groups

Salon D, Salons ABC and Salon Foyer

Delegates will choose one of the three breakout groups to attend below.

I: Price Discovery and Dealer Selection Innovation

Salon D

The price discovery and dealer selection process for institutional US corporate bond trading has not changed in 20 years. Just as NASDAQ revolutionized equity trading by bringing market participants into the digital age, new technology promises to streamline institutional workflow by delivering the reliable, up-to-the-minute information you need to make better block trading decisions.

Discussion Leader:

Chris White, CEO, BondCliQ

II: Ingesting, Evaluating, and Interacting with Broker Axes

Salons ABC

Discussion Leader:

Spencer Lee, Head of Client Products, Americas, MarketAxess

III. Primary Market Automation

Salon Foyer

Discussion Leader:

Robert Fink, Buyside Relationship Manager, North America, Coalition Greenwich

2:45–3:30

Using Technology to Manage Complexity in Fixed Income SMAs

Salons ABC

Fixed income separately managed accounts for retail investors are growing fast. Individual investors and their financial advisors like fixed income SMAs, both taxable and tax-exempt, because they can be customized and tax-managed. But the large number of accounts and the greater complexity and relative illiquidity of fixed income markets pose substantial challenges to asset managers. How can buy-side firms use technology to make that operational complexity tractable?

Moderated by:

Robert Fink, Buyside Relationship Manager, North America, Coalition Greenwich

Panelists:

- Andrew Claeys, Senior Securities Trader, Head of Systematic Trading, Systematic, Allspring Global Investments
- Jay Vlosich, Portfolio Manager & Trader, Brown Advisory

3:30–4:15

Q&A with Commissioner Hester M. Peirce

Salons ABC

Keynote Speaker:

Hester M. Peirce, Commissioner, U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission

Interviewed by:

Meaghan Dugan, Senior Vice President and Head of U.S. Options, Cboe Global Markets

4:15

Conference Concludes